

Farm Fresh & Ready: How Farmers Markets Support Sustainability in the Santa Barbara Community

Mila Matich



Image taken from Santa Barbara Farmers Market ("The Santa Barbara Certified Farmers' Market")

Starting to shop for yourself is hard. Take myself for example. I grew up in a household where I had my meals cooked for me. I went on to live in a dorm with an accompanying dining hall in my first year at college, and then I lived in my sorority house that had a chef that cooked for us 7 days a week, 2 meals a day for my second year. That being said, I only ever stepped into a grocery store to buy snacks, not so much groceries.

This year is my first year taking charge for myself. I now have to cook for myself, grocery shop and do all the planning, prepping and research needed. To say this was overwhelming would be an understatement. Being an environmentalist at heart, I took this as a new challenge to be able to minimize my carbon footprint in another aspect of my life: food.

I have always loved shopping at farmers' markets, ever since I was a little girl, my Nana would always take me to our local one to buy groceries and get lunch. Since being abroad in Australia, I learned about the culture around farmers' markets. Many people get their produce from here, and they served as a meeting place and gathering of

friends and family. Seeing this, I have been intrigued to learn more about them and their possible benefits to help myself achieve the sustainable lifestyle I strive for.

There is so much hidden food waste and atrocities that are not talked about enough behind the industrialized food industry. Additionally, we are always told to shop locally and support local businesses, however we fail to understand why and how these habits are beneficial not only to us but to our environment. While industrial agriculture dominates grocery store shelves, farmers' markets offer a community-based alternative that encourages sustainability, strengthens local economies, and improves public health. The article will aim to address the large issues within the large industrial food system, how farmers' markets combat it, the benefits of shopping locally, and finally end with a list of local farmers' markets in the Santa Barbara area. In doing so, I hope to raise awareness and purpose a different way of life to others who are dealing with the new responsibility of feeding ourselves and shopping on our own, but also to those who are looking to reduce their environmental impact, and live a greener life.

The Industrialized Food Industry



Image taken by John Vachon, 1941. From a Public domain. ("Industrialization of Agriculture")

Supermarkets are a staple in communities, especially at UCSB. Albertson's, Costco, Target. We know them, and we love them, but unfortunately, most items in these stores are products of the industrialized food industry.

The industrialized food system consists of large-scale corporations that control food production, processing, and distribution. These include large-scale agriculture and livestock. These systems feed into the beloved supermarkets, convenience stores, and restaurants within communities. These are convenient, easy, and help feed families and college students globally. However,

they aren't as great as they seem. The industrialized food industry slowly kills our planet through its unsustainable practices, fossil fuel consumption, and waste generation.

Monoculture is one of the biggest proponents of the faults of industrialized food. Monoculture is the practice of growing a single crop species over a large area to boost productivity and maximize output. This practice has led to the homogenization of the food supply. For example, out of the 7,000 species typically grown in farms, only 150 are grown today, and countries like the United States have lost more than 90% of food varieties (Nortberg-Hodge). This is because most agriculture is focused on products like corn, rice, and wheat, which are

easiest to produce in large quantities (Norberg-Hodge). This decreases biodiversity within farms, making crops vulnerable to disease and more susceptible to catastrophe (Norberg-Hodge).

Monoculture also leads to a heavy reliance on chemicals within the agricultural industry, including but not limited to fertilizers, pesticides, and herbicides (Sosso). These are aimed at enhancing crop growth within agricultural fields, while killing unnecessary pests and prey that may be damaging the food (Sosso). However, in doing so, these chemicals also kill all other weeds, insects, and animal habitats. These species can be known as “non-target species”, similar to the concept of by-catch within fisheries. Essentially, it is the killing and harming of organisms who are not the intended target of the initiative, which in this case is chemicals. Additionally, chemical usage alters the microbiology within the soil by depleting its essential nutrients, leading to poor environmental management (Sosso).

The reliance on large chemical inputs also creates dead zones in the nearby waters (Norberg-Hodge). Through rain and runoff, fertilizers travel to streams and ponds, leading to eutrophication, an intense growth rate of algae. This depletes the water of its oxygen, affecting local fish and disrupting the local food chain balance (Sosso). As more chemicals are used, crops develop genetic resistance. Then, agricultural managers must use more chemicals, which amplify their negative effects on local ecosystems.



Image taken by Dan Davidson, 2010. Creative Commons ("Industrialization of Agriculture")



Image sourced from Pesticide Action and Archeology Network ("Big Ag's Dirty Little Secret")

With large-scale farms and monoculture comes large-scale equipment and operations, both of which contribute significantly to our global greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions. Energy consumption is high due to this reliance on large equipment in processing, packaging, and transporting goods. In fact, global food systems' greenhouse gas emissions account for one-third of our total global emissions (Norberg-Hodge). This is a significant contribution to our climate crisis and is certainly not helping us move toward a sustainable future.

Lastly, global food systems generate large amounts of waste. Most of the food grown within these large operations is not up to par to be sold in our local grocery stores. They are either defective, not properly shaped, too small, or, for lack of a better word, not “pretty” enough and appealing to the consumer. These “deformed”



Image taken by Vadim Zakirov/zakirov, Adobe Stock (Damon)

products get thrown out, unused, despite being perfectly edible (Norberg-Hodge). As a result of the strict standardization requirements of supermarkets, roughly half of the global food supply is being wasted or lost, which counteracts their motto of being efficient (Norberg-Hodge).

There are just some of the many faults of our global food systems. However, these can be avoided based on how consumers put their money and support. For instance, other systems such as farmers' markets help counteract these faults and contribute to generating a more sustainable lifestyle by promoting sustainable consumption.

Local vs. Industrial: How Farmers' Markets Combat the Cons

First and foremost, a farmers' market is defined as a local market that sells locally grown produce, meats, cheeses, and other products that are directly delivered to the consumer. Markets are one way consumers can push back against the atrocities of the industrialized food system and help foster sustainable consumption and practices (Sustainable Agriculture Network). So, what makes these markets so good?

For one, local farmers do not rely on monoculture. Rather, many of their practices counteract those seen in industrialized agriculture. One of these practices is intercropping, the practice of growing two or more crops simultaneously in the same field, most commonly done by using the spaces between rows of one crop to grow another (Norberg-Hodge). By doing so, farmers diversify their crops, providing more niches, or ecological roles, for wildlife. Higher rates of biodiversity also minimize the effects of disasters, as there is more genetic diversity within a field, equipped with



Image taken by Zoltan Munka (Unplash)

different mechanisms to fight disease, pests, and environmental disasters (Sustainable Agriculture Network.). Additionally, intercropping generates a wide variety of food, which encourages the biodiversity mentioned earlier, but also focuses on providing more food variety to consumers (Sustainable Agriculture Network). Smaller farms are less focused on crops with large yields that are cheap to produce in large amounts. Thus, counteracting the practice of the industrialized food industry, and promoting and sustaining ecosystem health.

Along with intercropping, diversity is supported by growing produce during the proper growing seasons (Norberg-Hodge). We often hear about fruit seasons, such as pomegranate season or sumo orange season. However, most industrialized agricultural practices ignore traditional growing seasons. Ignoring growing seasons leads to the need for genetic modification of produce and pesticide usage (Norberge-Hodge). Adhering to growing seasons reduces reliance on GMOs and pesticides in small farming. In fact, by supporting and focusing on crops during their unique growing season, local farmers reduce their chemical usage (Norberg-Hodge) and decrease damage to local ecosystems.

Along the same lines of reduced chemical reliance, local farmers do not need to worry about the immense transportation between the producer and consumer. Again, this direct producer-to-consumer pipeline decreases GHG emissions associated with transportation and reduces the amount of chemicals used, as they do not need to be preserved for as long during travel.



Image taken by [Joelao Goncalves](#)(Unsplash)

Generally, small-scale farming practices tend to be more sustainable than large-scale farming. Because smaller farms spend less on transportation and large equipment, they are able to invest more into environmentally friendly practices, and pay more attention to crop production, which improves food resilience and food security (Sustainable Agriculture Network). As a result of the increased level of care and oversight, there is often less food waste associated with local farming than industrial farming (Norberg-Hodge).

However, one may argue that the goals within the industrialized food industry are focused on increasing output and efficiency, which may not be achieved on such a small scale. While not entirely incorrect, researchers found that, measured by output per acre, smaller farms are 8-10 times more productive (Norberg-Hodge).

Additionally, rather than focusing on productivity and efficiency, local farms, like those in the Santa Barbara area, are committed to fostering sustainable practices that promote sustainable environments (“The Santa Barbara Certified Farmers’ Market”). In sum, farmers’ markets promote and support long-term sustainable

agriculture through practices by focusing more on the crops they tend to and the reduced reliance on large-scale equipment and chemicals that are known to harm the environment (Sustainable Agriculture Network).

But Wait, there's more !

There are more benefits to farmers' markets in addition to promoting ecosystem health and sustainability! Farmers' markets both positively impact your own health, your local community, and the farmers themselves!

Health Benefits to Farmers' Markets

Mentioned previously was the reduced travel time between products and the store due to farmers' markets (i.e. the direct producer-to-consumer pipeline). Aside from preventing excessive pesticide and chemical usage to ensure the success of the travel and storage process, reduced travel time also benefits your health (Onque).



Image taken by Stephanie Garson at Camino Real Marketplace / Daily News (Chavez and Garson)

Farmers' markets provide communities with fresh produce, not the "fresh" advertised in supermarkets, actually fresh (John Hopkins Medicine). Produce from local farms spends more time on the farm than in transit (John Hopkins Medicine). In fact, most things produced by local farms arrive at the market within 24 hours of being harvested (Onque). Fruits and vegetables also oxidize over time, which is more commonly seen as the browning of produce, and it "going bad". This process is accelerated when produce is spent so much time in large trucks traveling across the country, as mentioned by New York Dietitian Reyna

Franco (Onque). Not only does this diminish the freshness of your food, it also diminishes the quality of the produce you are purchasing at the supermarket, especially when those products are supposed to be "out of season" (Onque).

The fact that farmers' markets align with the proper growing seasons of produce also benefits your health. Dietitians suggest that buying produce within its natural growing season contains more nutrients and a so-called "superior food experience" than when you buy produce on the shelf that is out of season (Sustainable Agriculture Network).

Beyond fresh produce, shopping at local markets can encourage healthier diets and eating habits, which in turn leads to improved health. In a study done by the University of Wisconsin-Madison, researchers found that 75% of frequent market attenders reported that they began eating healthier after purchasing from farmers' markets

(Division of Extension). Not only are you getting better, more nutritious food, farmers' markets also influence consumers to begin a healthier lifestyle by encouraging more nutritious eating habits. So, in order to get fresh, good quality, nutrient-rich food, shop at your local farmers' markets!

Community Benefits to Farmers' Markets

In addition to the environment and your own health, communities benefit an extreme amount from farmers' markets, both socially and economically.



Image taken by Luke Scimmon at the Saturday Santa Barbara Market (Kettmann)

Socially, farmers' markets provide a deep sense of community within a town or a neighborhood (Alonzo). They provide local residents with access to fresh, locally produced items, along with other commercial goods like pastries, and sometimes feature food vendors. Markets can be a place for social events for the entire community, with live music, activities, and opportunities to eat spectacular food. Families can bring their loved ones, like how I used to go with my Nana back at home, and friends can gather with other friends. These markets are also a place to meet new people, including neighbors, other students, local residents, and the farmers and merchants themselves (Alonzo).

This also highlights the increased connection markets foster, as the dynamic between producers and consumers is more direct. Building a connection with those who grow your food can help consumers better understand where their food is coming from and develop trust within food systems, something that the industrialized

system lacks (Sustainable Agriculture Network). Markets frequently host education events that give community members the opportunity to learn more about the farm, as well as gardening techniques and cooking demonstrations (Alonzo). These experiences allow consumers to make informed decisions about what they buy, how to use it, and also learn how to grow some of their own food at home (Sustainable Agriculture Network).



Image taken by Luke Stinson at the Saturday Santa Barbara Market (Bloomberg)

Community relationships and producer-to-consumer connections are often lost as individuals do not shop locally. However, shopping at farmers' markets is a good way to bring that aspect back into our day-to-day lives. For example, when I go to the Tuesday Santa Barbara market to buy my bread, I always talk with the local bakers. In doing so, I was able to learn about the history of his small business, how he uses the recipes his grandmother taught him, and how he hopes to bring people joy with his food as his grandmother once did for him. By

building these relationships, we will develop a stronger community, one with greater connections with others, and foster a greater appreciation for sustainable practices and food in general, which is often overlooked and taken for granted.

On the economic side of things, farmers' markets benefit the community's economy. In general, money spent at farmers' markets stays within the local economy, leading to economic development and job creation (Alonzo).

Whereas, in industrialized industries, farmers and producers get a small portion of the profit, and money is not circulated within the local community where it is generated (Alonzo). To add on to the sense of community it builds, the increase in local activity promotes local businesses, both those that are sold within and nearby the market, which benefit from foot traffic (Brown and Miller). Additionally, oftentimes local businesses can sell their goods at markets too, including artwork, candles, clothing, and other non-food related items. Overall, farmers' markets have a strong influence on the local economy.



Image taken by Luke Stinson at the Saturday Santa Barbara Market (Bloomberg)

Local farming also provides more jobs. As mentioned earlier, these farms pay closer attention to detail than industrialized agriculture. As a result, they rely less on large-scale machinery and more on labor, leading to an increase in on-farm employment (Brown and Miller). In

addition, farmers' markets create jobs for individuals who help sell and distribute these goods within the local community. A 2004 survey in West Virginia found that farmers' markets had a positive net impact on the state's economy, generating nearly 800 jobs directly from farmers' markets and 1,145 jobs in related activities (Brown and Miller). So, if the local economy and job generation are something that matters to you, then what more can incentivize you to support your local markets?

Addressing the Price

It's no secret that farmers' markets tend to be on the expensive side. I guarantee that as you read this, you are thinking: okay, this is great, but with whose money? And yes, that is a great point, and what drives most people away from shopping there. But what if I told you that it wasn't as bad as you'd think? With rising inflation and prices, the difference between grabbing some produce at your supermarket and your local farmers' market may not be so bad!

So first of all, why is it so expensive? After all, there is a reason for everything. Farmers' markets aren't just more expensive because they can be; there are things that they do that industrialized farms don't do that raise the cost. Methods of agriculture within these small farms are often more sustainable and labor-intensive than conventional farming (Sustainable Agriculture Network). The reason food at the supermarket is "cheaper" is that they opt out of these environmentally friendly practices that raise the cost of agriculture to ensure maximum profit and yield. They also focus on what's cheaper, and have policies in place, such as hidden subsidies on those easy-to-produce foods like corn, wheat, and rice mentioned earlier. The monoculture of these crops makes it cheap (Norberg-Hodge), but this comes at a huge environmental cost rather than an "out-of-pocket" cost.

If price is also a major concern, the Santa Barbara Farmers Markets accept CalFresh EBT, which is a program that grants students and individuals monthly electronic benefits that can be used to purchase food. Using the money granted by CalFresh EBT, you can purchase tokens at the Market Information Booth, which in turn can be used to purchase fresh fruits and vegetables ("The Santa Barbara Certified Farmers' Market")!

However, the difference in prices from the farmers' market to the supermarket may not be as big as you think. With rising inflation, the price of eating at home has increased by 12.2%, and 10.4% of that is attributed to the rise in the cost of food (Onque). This decreases and narrows the gap between the two modes of consumption. For example, bananas at NC State Farmers Public Market cost 63 to 85 cents per pound. At local chain supermarkets, it is 59 cents per pound. Some are also cheaper as carrots cost 66 to 72 cents at the market and 69 cents per pound at the supermarket (Onque). I also found that buying avocados at farmers' markets is cheaper.



Image taken by Stephanie Gerson at Camino Real Marketplace/ Daily News (Gerson and Gerson)

At the local Tuesday downtown market, I bought 3 large avocados for \$3, whereas at Trader Joes it cost me \$5 to buy a 3-pack of smaller avocados!



Image taken from the Department of Agricultural Economics (Thompson)

Local farmers also aim to reduce food waste and sell the majority of what they bring to sell on market days. That means, as the day is slowing down and getting closer to closure, vendors will likely reduce their prices to sell goods faster (Onque). Additionally, some products may be cheaper at the market than at local grocery stores, you just have to do the research in order to find out. Therefore, if you really want to be cheap, you can shop strategically to get the best deals on some of the best products at markets!

Closing Remarks

Our current food production systems and methods are one of the largest sources of human-induced environmental change (Sosso), so it is important we take the actions needed to address the change and try to make it a positive one. One way of doing so is to shop at local farmers' markets.

Farmers' markets can be thought of as “keystones for rebuilding local food systems by making food more visible and educating customers” (Brown and Miller). Mending our relationship with food and developing a greater connection and appreciation for it will allow us to take a step toward a more sustainable lifestyle.

Supporting local businesses, especially small farms, is important. Being a local farmer can be challenging, especially in an industry often driven by the “get big or get out” mentality, which pushes many smaller farmers out of the business or forces them to join the larger industry (Norberg-Hodge). By supporting local farmers, we as consumers can help ensure that these farms can still exist. In turn, this support helps sustain local families, their job security, and promotes agricultural practices that prioritize environmental protection.



Image taken by Stephanie Gerson at Caroline Reid Marketplaces/ Daily News (Chavez and Gerson)

If there is one key takeaway from this article, it is that we must change our habits in order to support and protect our Earth. Ultimately, this boils down to putting your money where your mouth is. In an interview with Aquatic Biologist and Conservation Specialist Jose Bacallao, he explains that the first step to sustainability is

altering where you put your money and what businesses you support. “You have complete control over how you spend your money”, he says, “Find out how you spend your money and where your food comes from and choose wisely”. As young consumers, it is especially important to educate ourselves on the choices we make and be mindful of what businesses we support and why. Supporting environmentally friendly businesses and practices, particularly within the food industry, is a meaningful step in the right direction toward a more sustainable future.



Image from Santa Barbara Farmers Market ("The Santa Barbara Certified Farmers' Market")

Aside from all the environmental and economic benefits, going to farmers' markets has continued to be a fun pastime with my family and my friends. Like I mentioned, I used to go to my local farmers' market with my Nana on Tuesday's after school to grab lunch from one of the food vendors. To this day, when we go back to visit, the lady remembers our names and we catch up on everything we have been up to. Additionally, everytime I go back to the Tuesday Santa Barbara market, I say hi to the local baker and continue to make conversation with the local farmers. These markets are a great way to sustain these relationships that get lost online and in our day to day lives.

Now is the time to begin more sustainable habits. As young consumers, we have the opportunity to set a precedent for the way we live, while also influencing and educating others about small changes we can make to

benefit our environment, our community, and ourselves. The decisions we make today can shape decisions we make in the future, and also influence the generations that follow. Making these choices, such as shopping local at farmers' markets, is a simple yet meaningful step in the right direction.

I encourage you to visit one of the local farmers' markets nearby, talk with the farmers, and buy some fresh produce (the strawberries are amazing!), and maybe even bring, or make, a friend along the way!

Farmer's Markets Near You!

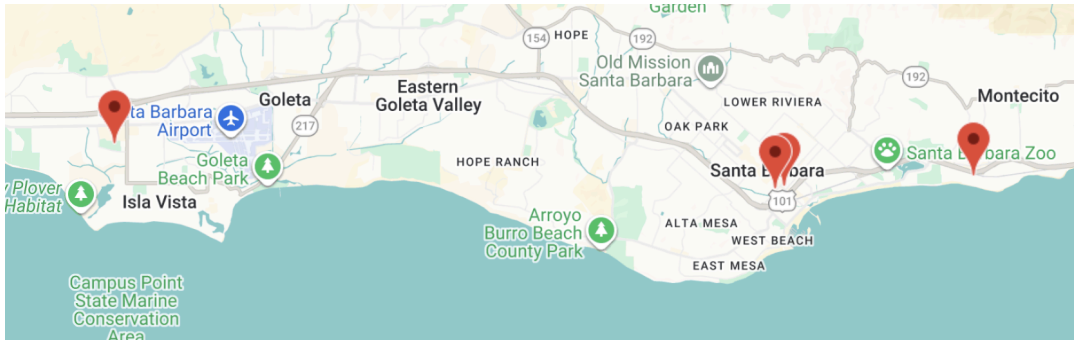


Image taken from [Santa Barbara Farmers Market](#)

Tuesday | Old Town Santa Barbara (3:00-6:30 p.m.)

600-800 blocks of State Street

From UCSB: 24x from Elings Hall Inbound & Get off @ SB MTD Transit Center

Friday | Montecito (8:00-11:15 a.m.)

Montecito Business Sector: 1100&1200 blocks, Coast Village Rd.

From UCSB: 24x from Elings Hall Inbound & Get off @ SB MTD Transit Center, transfer to bus 14 Montecito, East Valley & get off @ Coastal Village & Middle

Saturday | Downtown Santa Barbara (8:00 a.m. to 1:00 p.m.)

00 W. and 00 E. blocks of Carrillo Street & 900-1000 blocks of State Street

From UCSB: 24x from UCSB Elings Hall Inbound & Get off @ SB MTD Transit Center

Sunday | Camino Real Marketplace (10:00 a.m. to 2:00 p.m.)

7004 Marketplace Dr., Goleta

From UCSB: 11 or 24x from UCSB Elings Hall Outbound & Get off @ Stroke & Hollister 108

For more information, check out the [SB Farmers Markets Website!](#)

Works Cited

Alonzo, Anne L. "Farmers Markets as Community Centerpieces." *USDA*, U.S. Department of Agriculture , 5 Aug. 2013,

www.usda.gov/about-usda/news/blog/farmers-markets-community-centerpieces.

Bacalloa, Jose. "Personal Sustainability Interview". 6 February 2026

Brown, Cheryl, and Stacy Miller. "The Impacts of Local Markets: A Review of Research on Farmers Markets and Community Supported Agriculture (CSA)." *American Journal of Agricultural Economics*, vol. 90, no. 5, 2008, pp. 1296–302. *JSTOR*, <http://www.jstor.org/stable/20492388>.

Division of Extension. "Beyond Produce: National Survey Reveals Diverse Benefits of Farmers Market Attendance." News from Extension, University of Wisconsin-Madison , 10 Mar. 2025, fyi.extension.wisc.edu/news/2025/03/10/beyond-produce-national-survey-reveals-diverse-benefits-of-farmers-market-attendance/.

John Hopkins Medicine. "Health Benefits of Farmers Markets" *John Hopkins University*, www.hopkinsmedicine.org/health/wellness-and-prevention/health-benefits-of-farmers-markets.

Norberg-Hodge, Helena. "The Globalized, Industrialized Food System Is Destroying the World-We Urgently Need to Support Local Food Economies." *Resilience*, Resilience.org, 5 Nov. 2024,

www.resilience.org/stories/2024-11-05/the-globalized-industrialized-food-system-is-destroying-the-world-we-urgently-need-to-support-local-food-economies.

Onque, Renée. “Why Rising Inflation Means You Should Ditch Supermarkets for Your Local Farmers Market.” *CNBC: Make It*, CNBC, 24 July 2022,

www.cnn.com/2022/07/24/farmers-markets-vs-supermarkets-cost-differences-health-benefits.html.

“The Santa Barbara Certified Farmers’ Market.” *SB Farmers’ Markets*, Santa Barbara Certified Farmers Market Association, www.sbfarmersmarket.org/services-1. Accessed 9 Mar. 2026.

Sosso, Maria. “Problems with the Industrialized Food Economy // GreeND // University of Notre Dame.” *GoGreenND*, University of Notre Dame , 2018, gogreen.nd.edu/local-food/why-local/problems-with-the-industrialized-food-economy.

Sustainable Agriculture Network. “The Importance of Farmer’s Markets in Promoting Sustainable Agriculture.” *Sustainable Agriculture Network*, 26 June 2024, www.sustainableagriculture.eco/post/the-importance-of-farmer-s-markets-in-promoting-sustainable-agriculture.

Images Cited

“Big AG’s Dirty Little Secret: Pesticide Action & Agroecology Network (PAN).” Pesticide Action Network North America, PAN, 9 Dec. 2022, www.panna.org/resources/big-ags-dirty-little-secret/.

Chavez, Yuriko, and Stephanie Gerson. "Farmers Market Finds: Camino Real Marketplace: The Daily Nexus." *The Daily Nexus | The University of California, Santa Barbara's Independent, Student-Run Newspaper*, 21 Apr. 2022, dailynexus.com/2022-04-21/farmers-market-finds-camino-real-marketplace/.

Dutton, Jill. "In the Eye of the Beholder: How 'Ugly' Produce Is Reshaping the Food Waste Conversation." *THE PACKER*, www.thepacker.com/news/sustainability/eye-beholder-how-ugly-produce-reshaping-food-waste-conversation. Accessed 9 Mar. 2026.

González, Jordan. "Farming." *Unsplash*, 20 August 2022, <https://unsplash.com/photos/a-man-standing-on-a-train-track-next-to-a-lush-green-field-CQ49VvLZgdQ>

"Industrialization of Agriculture ." *Food System Primer*, Johns Hopkins, foodsystemprimer.org/production/industrialization-of-agriculture.

Kettmann, Matt. "Santa Barbara Farmers Market on the Move." *The Santa Barbara Independent*, 2 Oct. 2024, www.independent.com/2024/10/02/santa-barbara-farmers-market-on-the-move/.

Monika, Zuflan. "Intercropping land stock photo" *Unsplash*, 24 July 2025, https://media.istockphoto.com/id/2226605810/photo/intercropping-land.jpg?s=1024x1024&w=is&k=20&c=yd17C2nTOAObv3p-jNUpe_ycqg6A7PpIO0SsFooGnZQ=

“The Santa Barbara Certified Farmers’ Market.” *SB Farmers’ Markets*, Santa Barbara Certified Farmers Market Association, www.sbfarmersmarket.org/services-1. Accessed 9 Mar. 2026.

Thompson, M. "Farmers Market Prices: Trends from this Season." *Economic and Policy Update* (24):6, Department of Agricultural Economics, University of Kentucky, June 27th, 2024.